RESTRICTED

NG-CDF FAPM · FIELD ACTIVITY PLANNING AND MONITORING

Activity Memo Workflow

User guide: from signing in to the CEO's approval and authorisation

For	Heads of Department, the Assistant Chief of Staff, the Chief of Staff, the Chief Executive Officer, the System Administrator, and testers
Version	1.0, 15 October 2026
System	NG-CDF FAPM (activities.ngcdf.go.ke)

About the example in this guide

Every screen in this guide was captured from the working system using **test data only**. The example activity, "ICT Department Quarterly Systems Review and Staff Training", the people's names and the amount of **KES 250,000 are illustrative**. They are not an institutional plan, budget or authorisation.

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1. What the workflow is for

Every activity a department intends to carry out needs the CEO's approval and authorisation before it happens. The activity memo workflow moves that request through the right people in the right order, inside FAPM, and keeps a permanent record of every step.

1. The **Head of Department** writes the memo and submits it.
2. The **Assistant Chief of Staff** or the **Chief of Staff** reviews it. They can send it back for correction, comment on it, and then forward it.
3. The **CEO** approves and authorises it, declines it, or returns it for clarification.

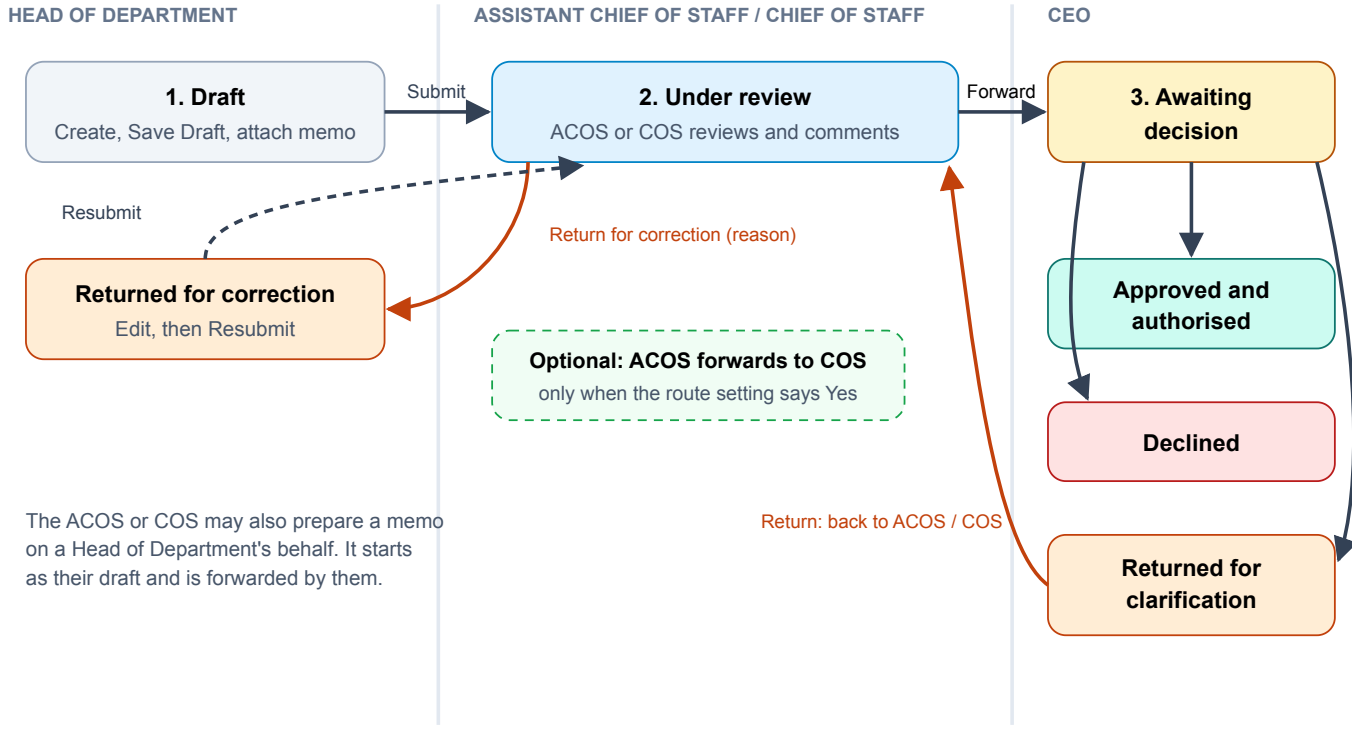
At every stage the memo shows its **status**, **who has it**, **what happens next** and the **latest comment**, so nobody has to ask where a memo is.

> **Good to know**
>
> - Forwarding a memo to the CEO is **not** an approval. Only the CEO's decision approves and authorises an activity.
> - Comments, returns and decisions are kept exactly as written. Nobody can edit or delete them afterwards.
> - A Head of Department sees only their own department's memos.

2. Who does what

Role	What they can do	What they cannot do
Head of Department (HOD)	Create memos for their department, save them as drafts, edit drafts, attach the signed memo and supporting documents, submit for review, correct and resubmit a returned memo, and follow every memo of their department to the CEO's decision.	Change a memo while it is being reviewed or decided. Approve anything. See other departments, the activity register, dashboards or reports.
Assistant Chief of Staff (ACOS)	Review memos sent to them, add comments and recommendations, return memos for correction, add the team and costs, forward to the CEO (or to the Chief of Staff if the route setting requires it), and prepare memos on a Head of Department's behalf.	Approve or decline. Act on a memo that is with the Chief of Staff.
Chief of Staff (COS)	Everything the Assistant can do, on any memo under review, plus following all memos in the Office of the CEO.	Approve or decline in the system.
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)	See memos forwarded for decision with all details, documents, comments and history. **Approve and authorise**, **Decline** (reason required) or **Return** for clarification (reason required).	Nothing is held back from the CEO.
System Administrator	Create and manage Head of Department accounts and link each to a department, reset passwords and two-factor sign-in, set the review route, and view the access and audit log.	See memo contents, review, or take any approval decision.

3. The workflow at a glance



What each status means

Status	Who has it	What happens next
Draft	The Head of Department (or the office preparing it on their behalf)	Finish the memo and submit it. Only the department can see its own drafts.
Under review	The Assistant Chief of Staff or the Chief of Staff, as shown on the memo	The reviewer comments, returns it for correction, or forwards it.
Returned for correction	The Head of Department	Make the corrections asked for and resubmit. It goes back to the reviewer who returned it.
Awaiting decision	The CEO	The CEO approves and authorises, declines, or returns it.
Returned (by the CEO)	The Chief of Staff and Assistant Chief of Staff	They answer the CEO's comments and forward it again, or return it to the Head of Department.
Approved	Nobody: decided	The activity is approved and authorised. The record shows who decided and when.
Declined	Nobody: decided	No further action. The CEO's reason is shown on the memo.

4. Signing in

1. Open FAPM in your browser and enter your NG-CDF email address and password.
2. The first time, read the Data Privacy Statement, tick the box to agree, and continue.
3. You land on your starting page. A Head of Department lands on **Activity memos**. The Office of the CEO lands on the dashboard and finds memos under **Activity memos** in the menu on the left.

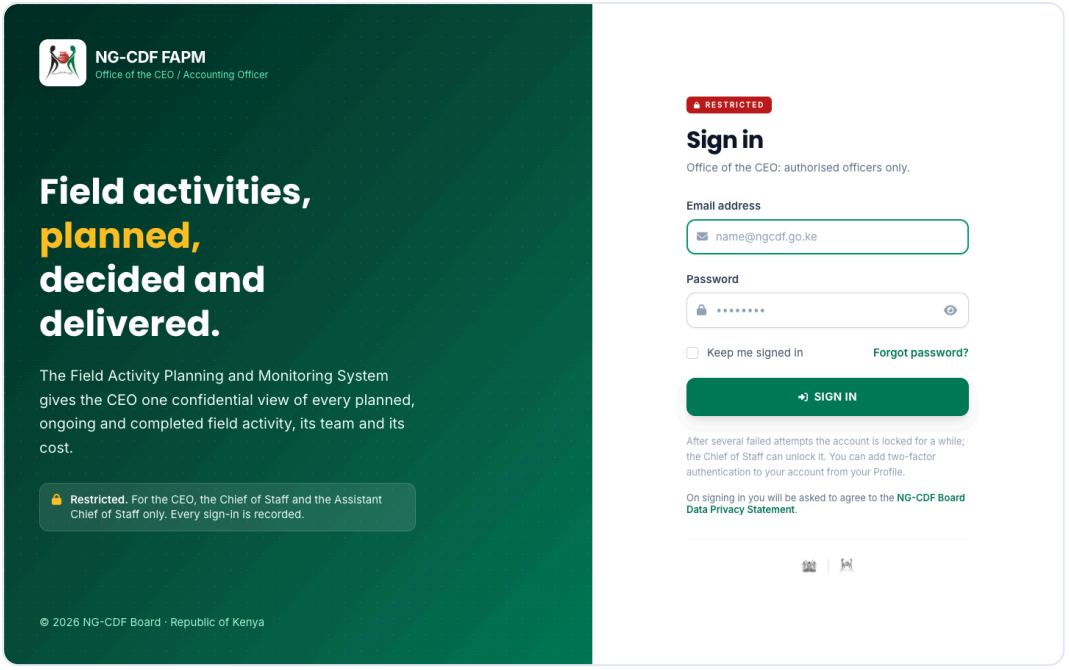


Figure 1. The sign-in page.

> **Tip**
> Two-factor sign-in can be switched on for your account under your name (top right) › Profile and security. The yellow number next to **Activity memos** counts the memos waiting for **you**.

> **Your session ends after 15 minutes without activity**
> This protects RESTRICTED information. Save your work as you go; drafts are kept.

5. Head of Department: create, save and submit a memo

5.1 Create the memo and save it as a draft

1. On **Activity memos**, press **Create new activity memo**.
2. Fill in the form. Fields marked * are required: **Title**, **Category**, **Purpose**, **Planned start** and **Number of days**. Your department is filled in for you and cannot be changed.
3. Fill in the rest as fully as you can: **Justification**, **Expected outcomes and deliverables**, **Participants and stakeholders**, the **Venue** (for example "NGCDF Board headquarters"), the **Estimated budget** and, if there is one, the **Budget line**.
4. Attach the **signed memo or concept note** (PDF, Word or image, up to 10 MB). You can also attach it later.
5. Press **Save draft**. The memo gets a reference number such as **FAPM-2026-27-00001**.

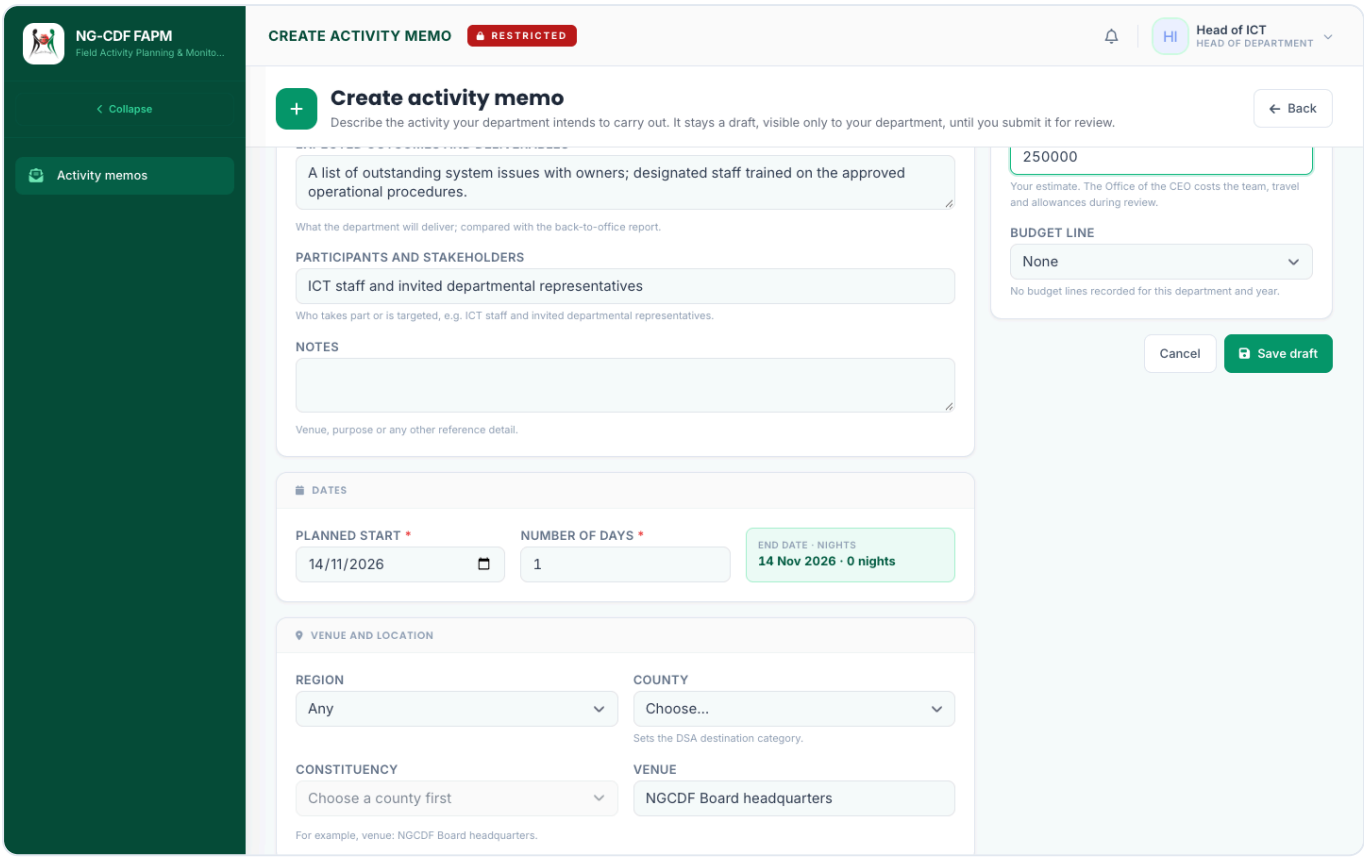


Figure 2. The memo form (lower part shown: participants, dates, venue, estimated budget). The end date and nights are worked out for you.

> **Fill in the justification**
> Reviewers often return memos that do not explain why the activity is needed now. In the example below, the Assistant Chief of Staff returns the memo for exactly this reason.

5.2 Check the draft

After saving you see the memo page. The blue note confirms it is still a draft that only your department can see. Use **Edit memo** to change it and the **Documents** panel to add supporting documents.

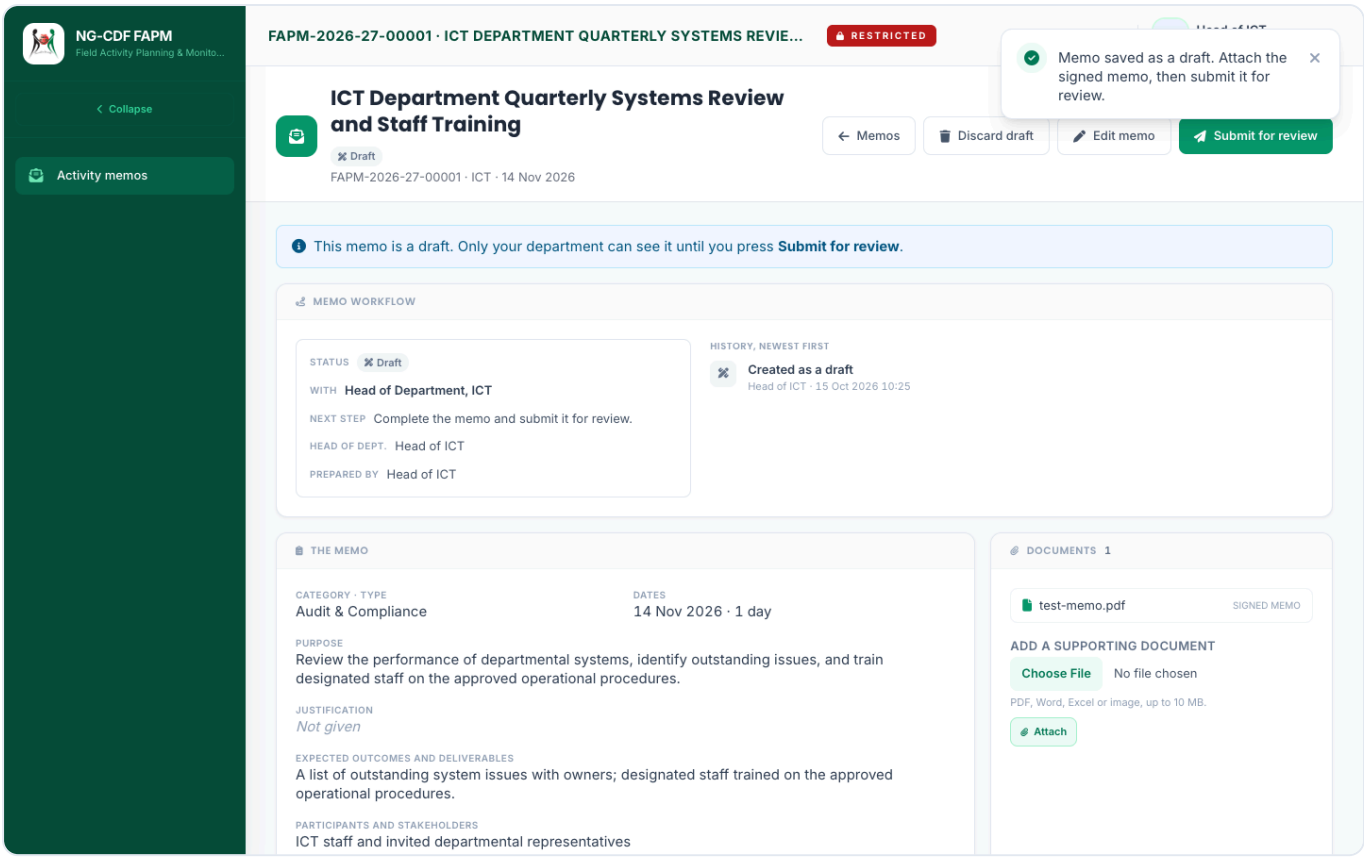


Figure 3. A saved draft: status, who has it, next step, and the memo's details and documents.

5.3 Submit for review

1. Press **Submit for review**.
2. Choose who reviews it: the **Assistant Chief of Staff** or the **Chief of Staff**. Add a note if you wish.
3. Press **Submit for review** in the popup to confirm. The reviewer is alerted at once.

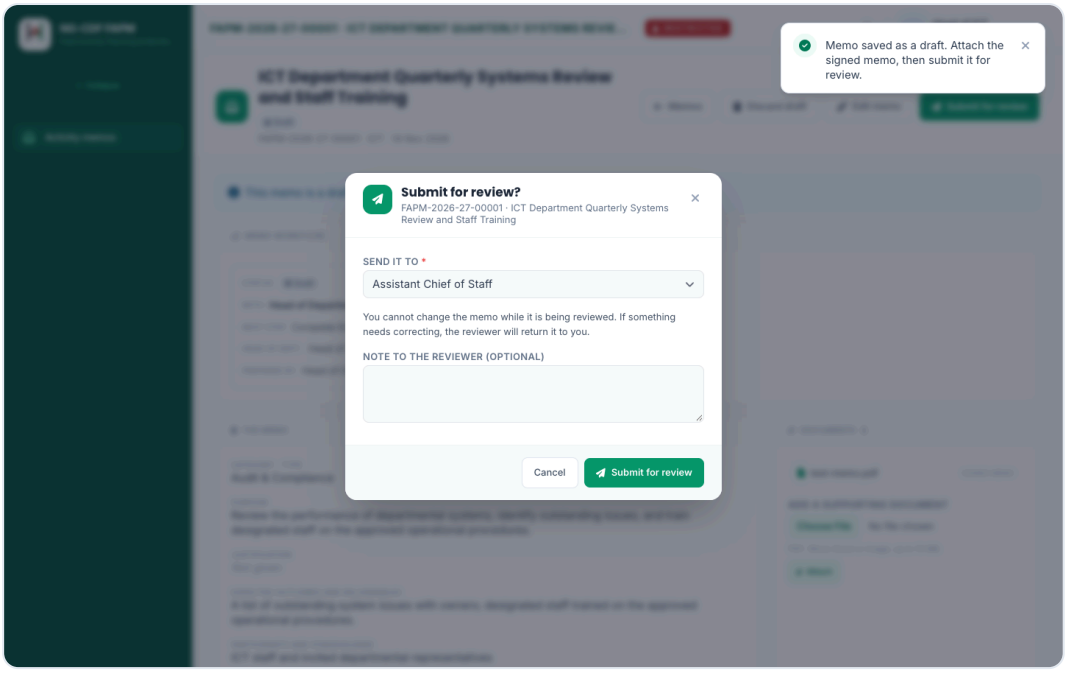


Figure 4. Confirming the submission and choosing the reviewer.

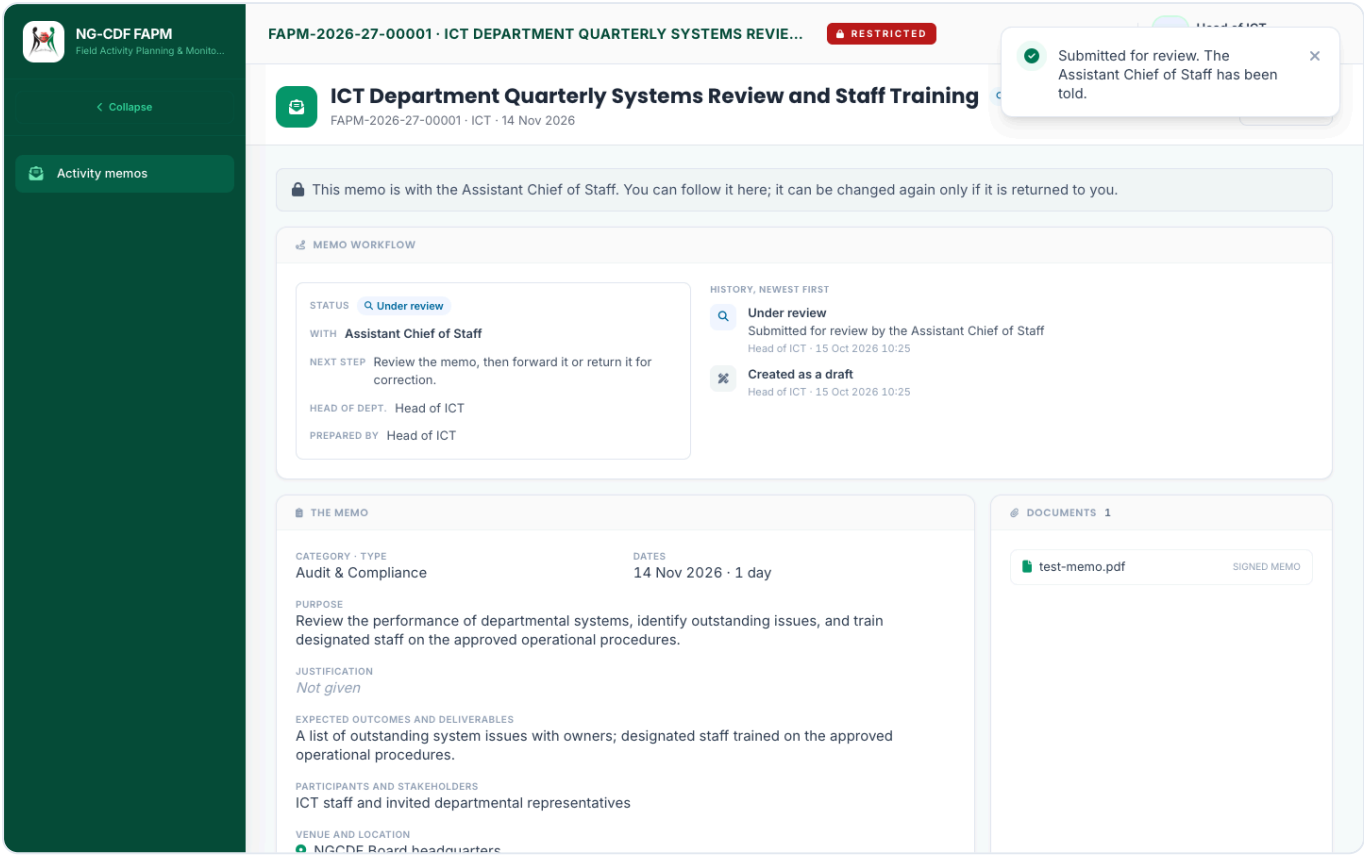


Figure 5. After submitting: status **Under review**, with the Assistant Chief of Staff. The memo is now locked for the department.

> **The system checks before it sends**
>
> You cannot submit until the memo has a **venue or location** and the **signed memo** is attached. A clear message tells you which is missing. Pressing Submit twice, or from two windows, sends it only once.

6. Reviewers: review, comment, return or forward

This section is for the Assistant Chief of Staff and the Chief of Staff.

6.1 Find what is waiting for you

Open **Activity memos**. The first tab, **Awaiting my review**, lists the memos with your office. Other tabs show memos returned by the CEO, memos back with Heads of Department, memos forwarded to the CEO, memos prepared on a Head of Department's behalf, and what you processed recently. The figures at the top count memos at each stage.

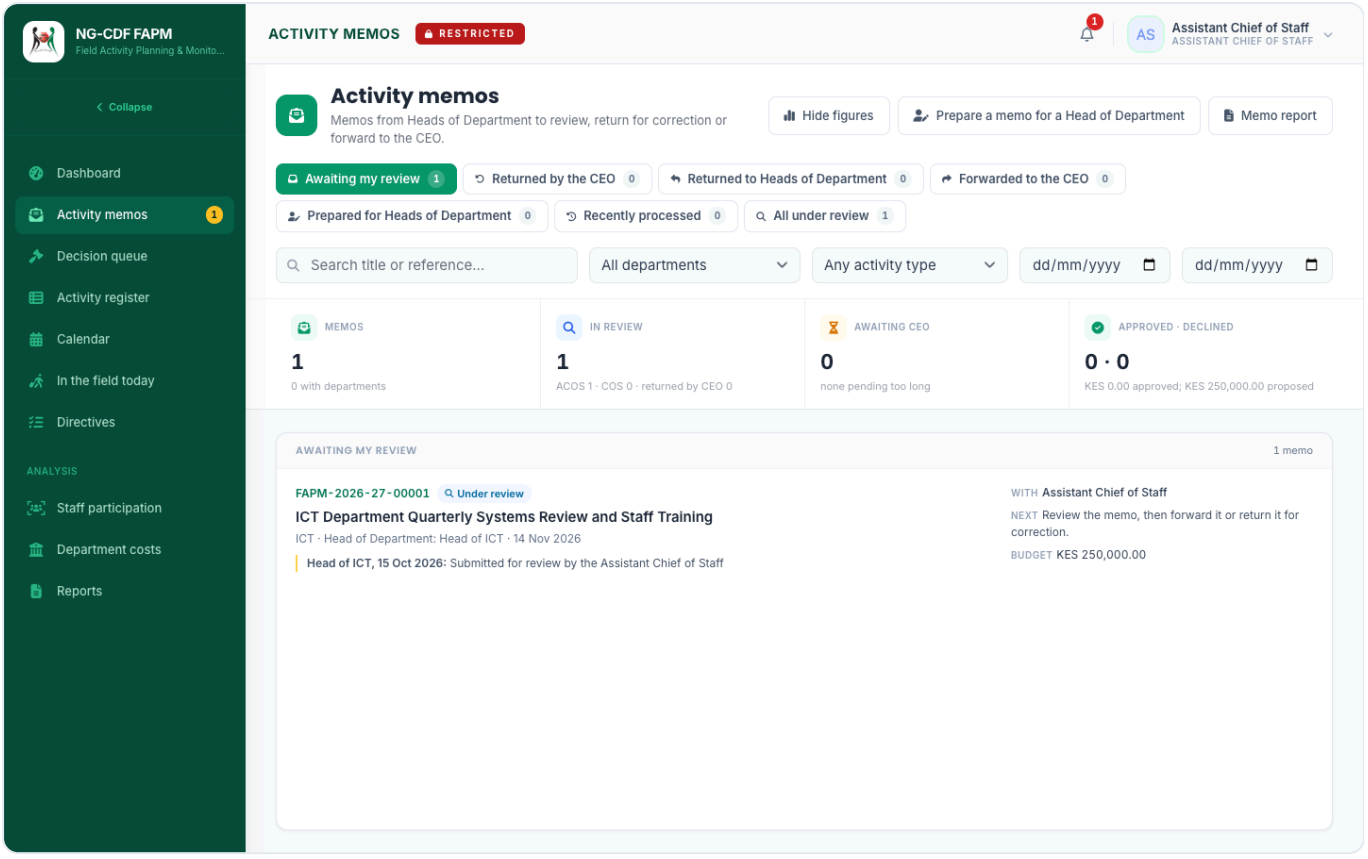


Figure 6. The Assistant Chief of Staff's memo board. Each memo shows its status, who has it, the next step, the budget and the latest comment.

6.2 Open and review the memo

Click the memo. The memo page shows the **Memo workflow** panel (status, who has it, next step, the Head of Department, who prepared it, and the full history), then the usual tabs: Overview, Team, Costs, Decisions and directives, Report and History. Open the attached documents from the Overview tab.

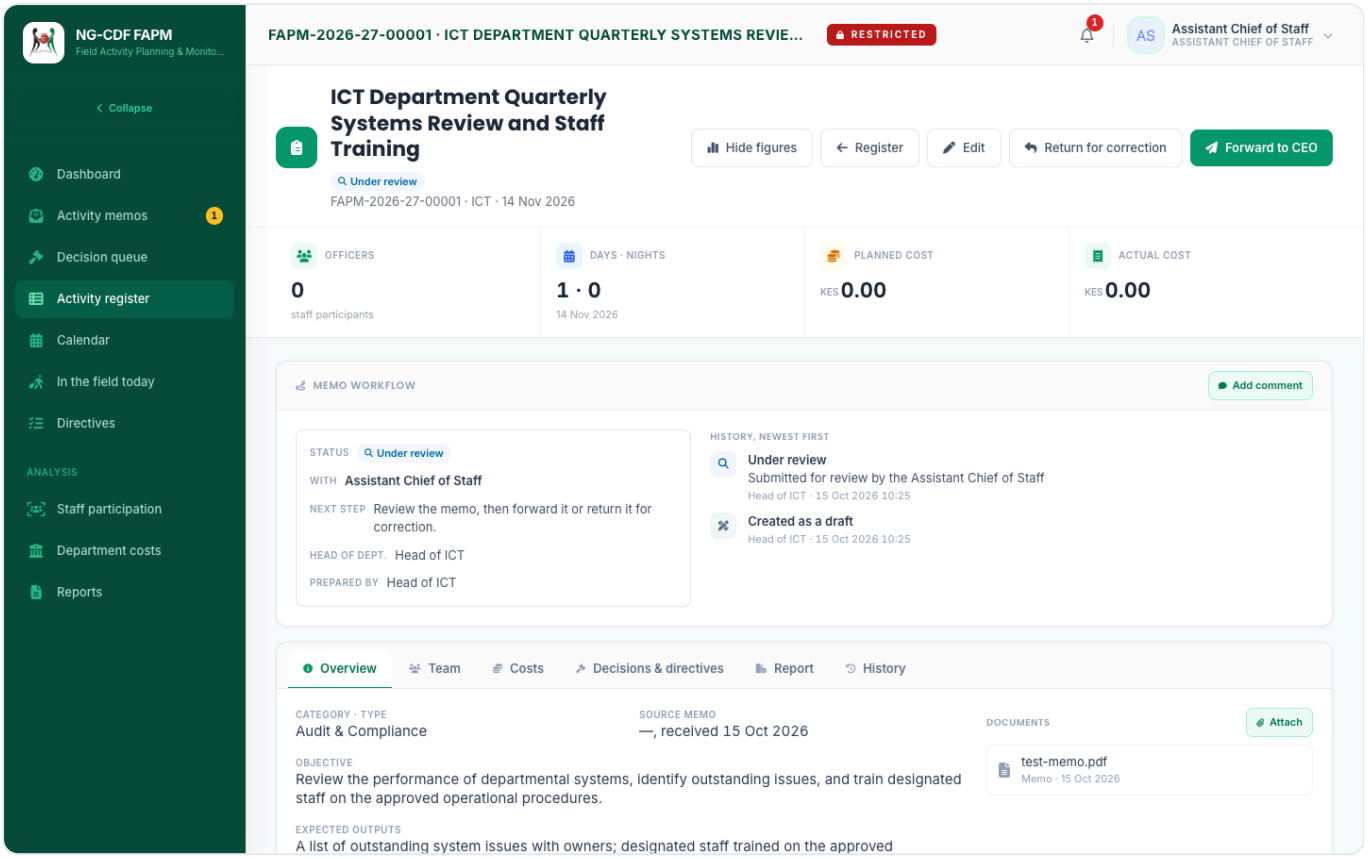


Figure 7. A memo under review, seen by the Assistant Chief of Staff, with **Return for correction**, **Forward to CEO** and **Add comment**.

- **Add comment** records a comment, optionally with a recommendation (Recommend approval, Recommend changes, Do not recommend). Comments cannot be edited or deleted.
- You may correct details yourself with `Edit` and build the **Team** and **Costs**. The CEO needs at least one staff participant.

6.3 Return for correction

1. Press **Return for correction**.
2. Say exactly what must be corrected. This is required.
3. Press **Return for correction** in the popup. The Head of Department is alerted and the memo is unlocked for them.

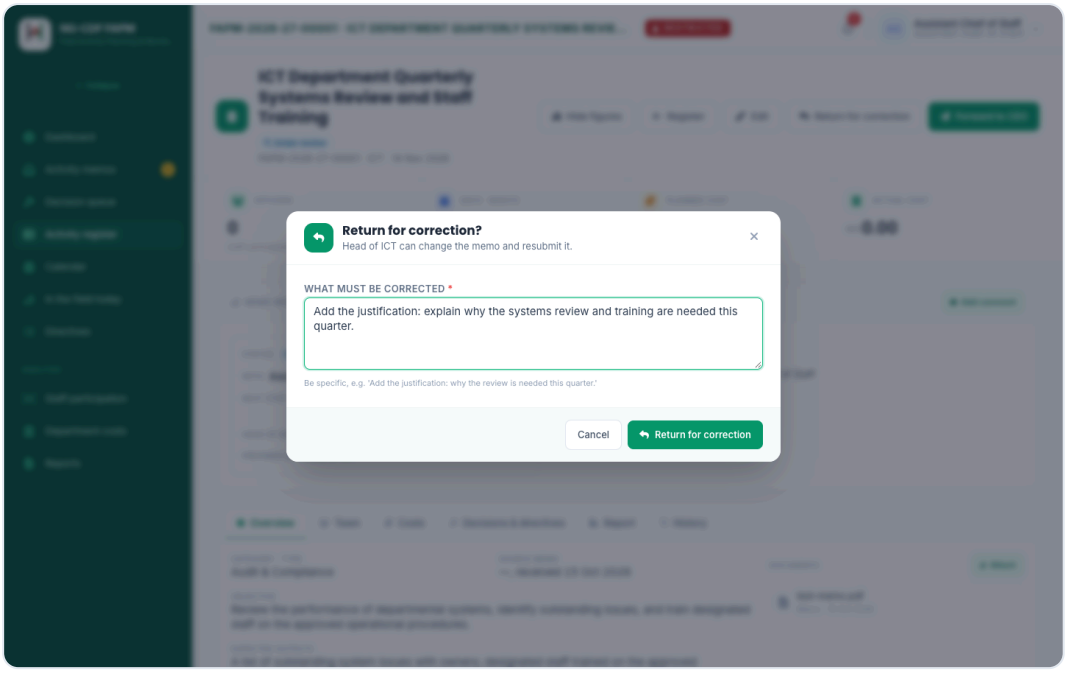


Figure 8. Returning the example memo for the missing justification.

6.4 Forward to the CEO

1. Make sure the memo has a staff participant (Team tab), a location and the signed memo.
2. Press **Forward to CEO**. Choose a recommendation and add a review comment if you wish.
3. Press **Forward to CEO** in the popup. The CEO and the Head of Department are alerted.

> **If the button says "Forward to Chief of Staff"**
> The System Administrator or Chief of Staff has set the route so that memos the Assistant reviews go to the Chief of Staff first. The Chief of Staff then forwards them to the CEO.

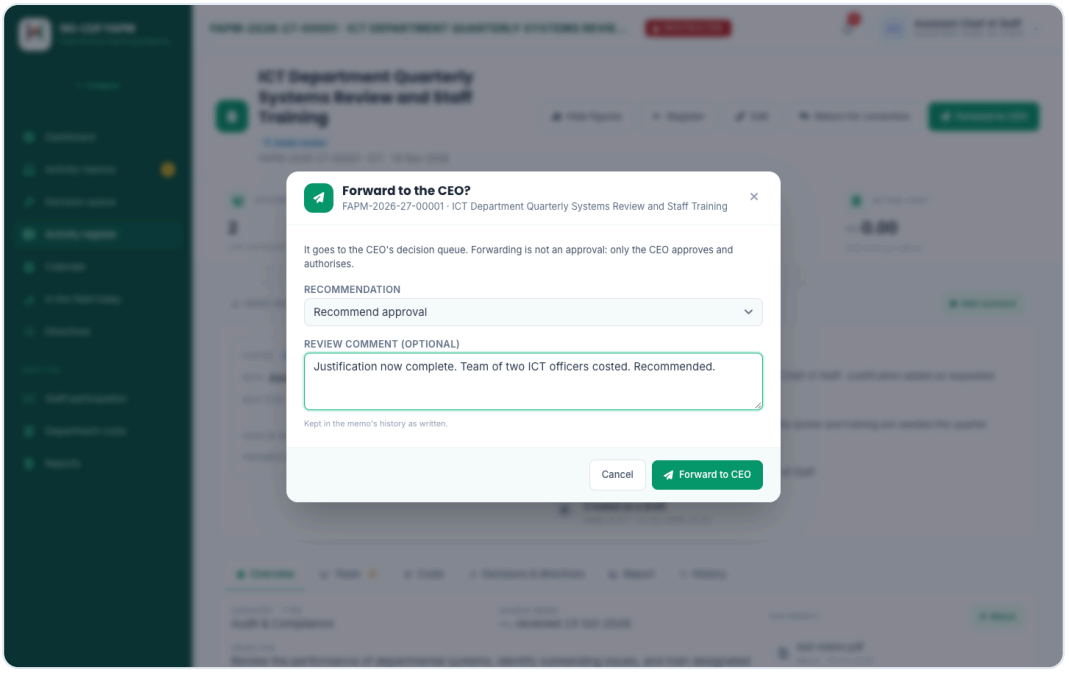


Figure 9. Forwarding with a recommendation. The popup reminds you that forwarding is not an approval.

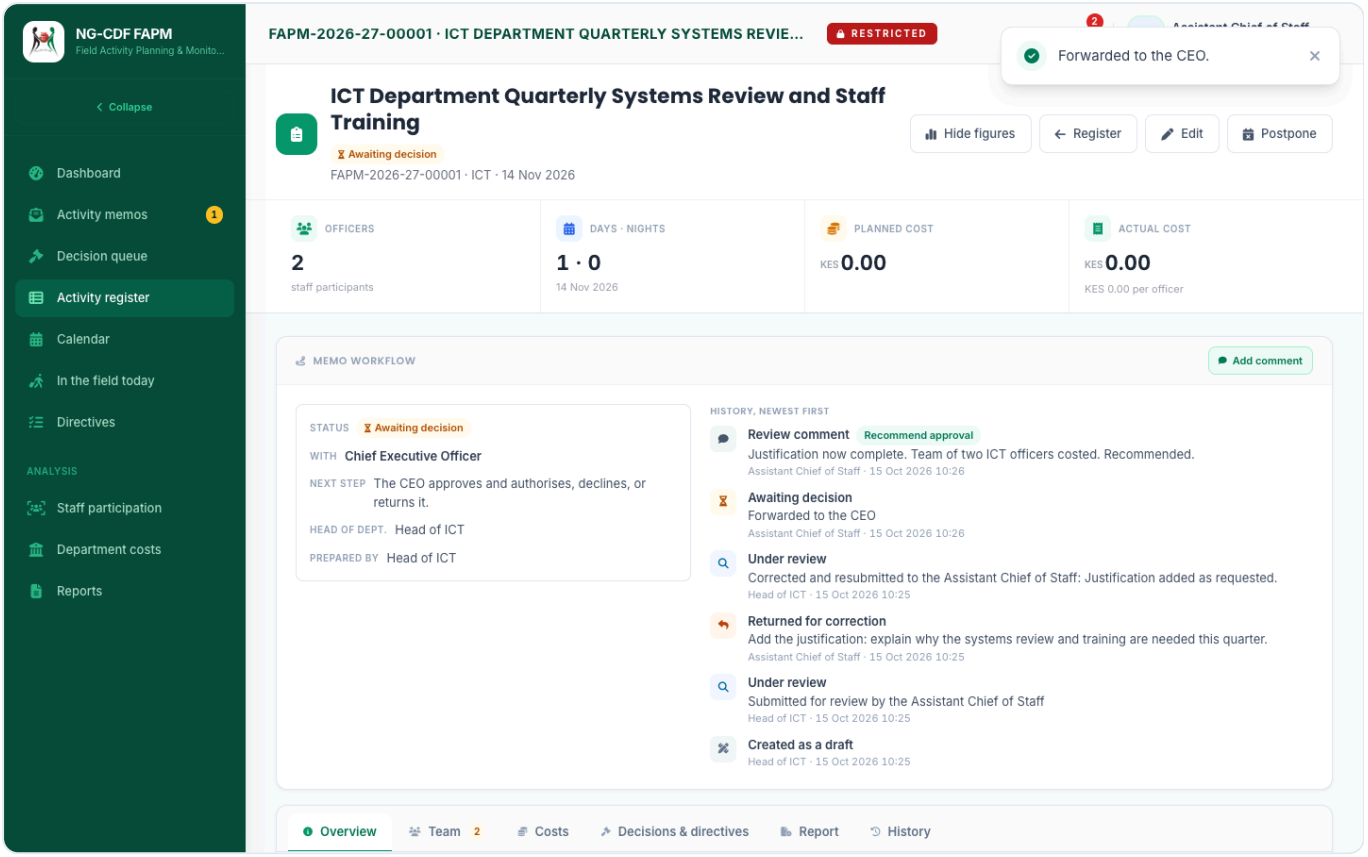


Figure 10. After forwarding: **Awaiting decision**, with the Chief Executive Officer. The history keeps the return, the resubmission and the recommendation.

7. Head of Department: correct and resubmit

1. When a memo is returned you get an alert (the bell at the top right) and the memo appears under the **Returned for correction** tab.
2. Open it. The orange box **What to correct** repeats the reviewer's words.
3. Press **Edit memo**, make the corrections, and press **Save changes**.
4. Press **Resubmit for review**, say briefly what you changed, and confirm. It goes back to the reviewer who returned it.

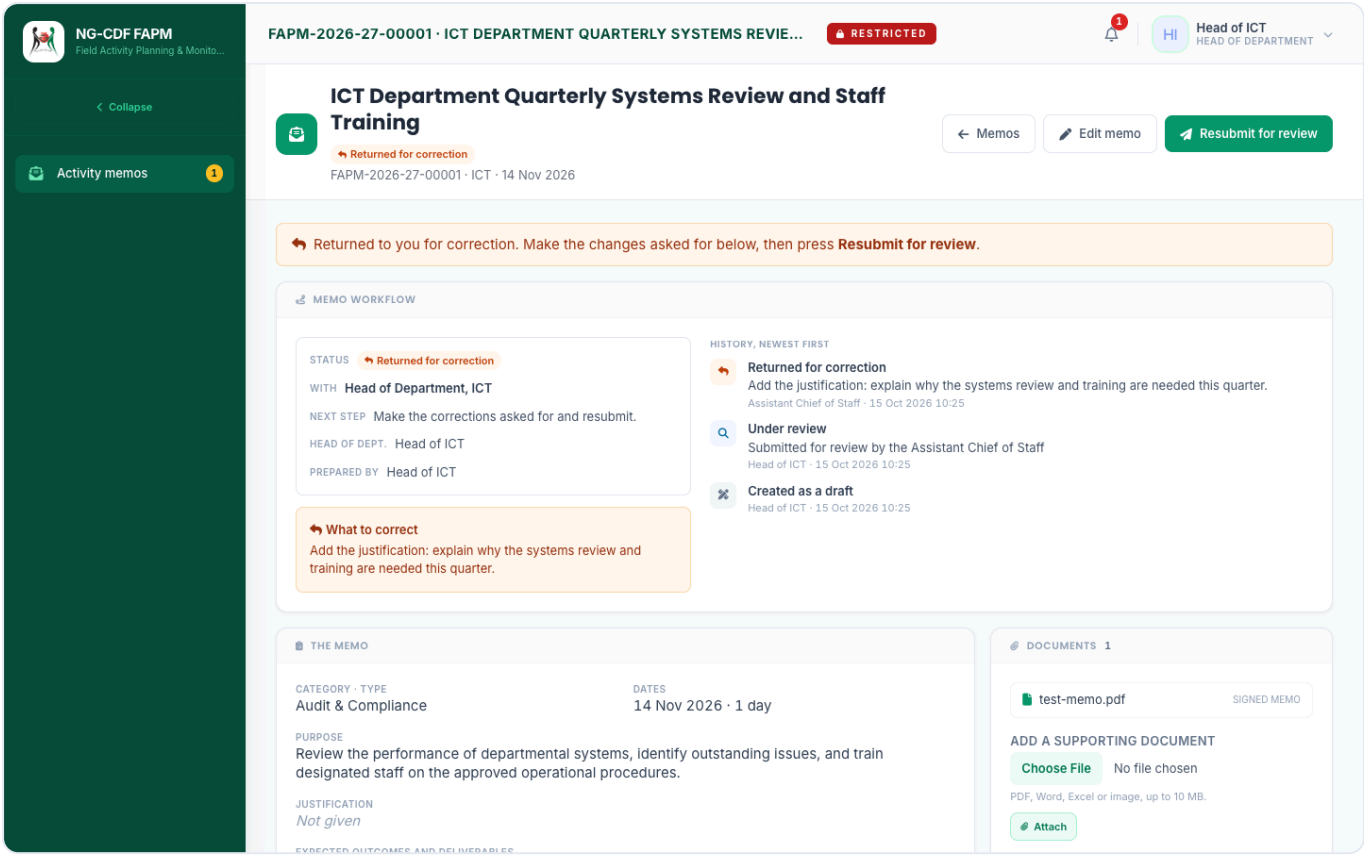


Figure 11. A memo returned to the Head of ICT, showing what to correct and the **Resubmit for review** button.

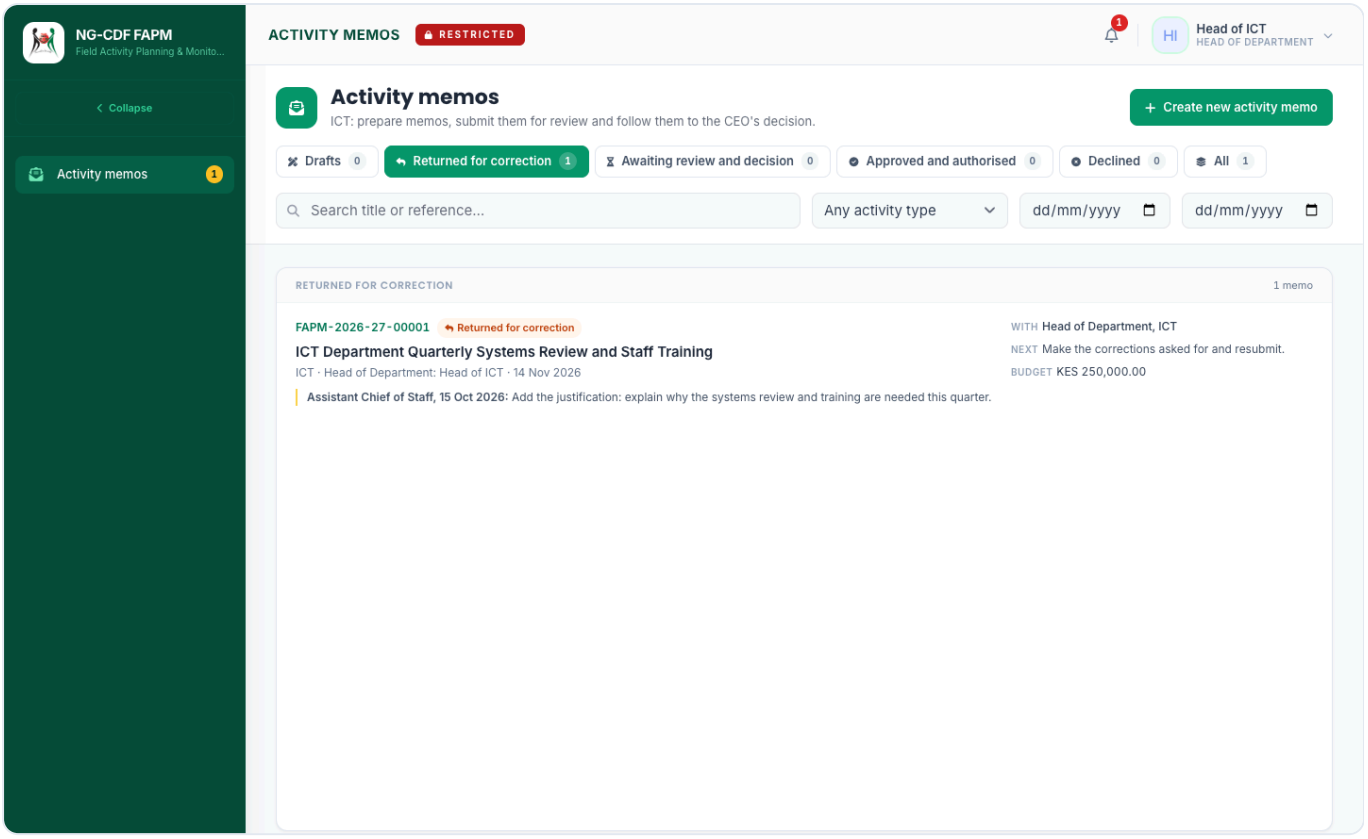


Figure 12. The Head of Department's board, **Returned for correction** tab.

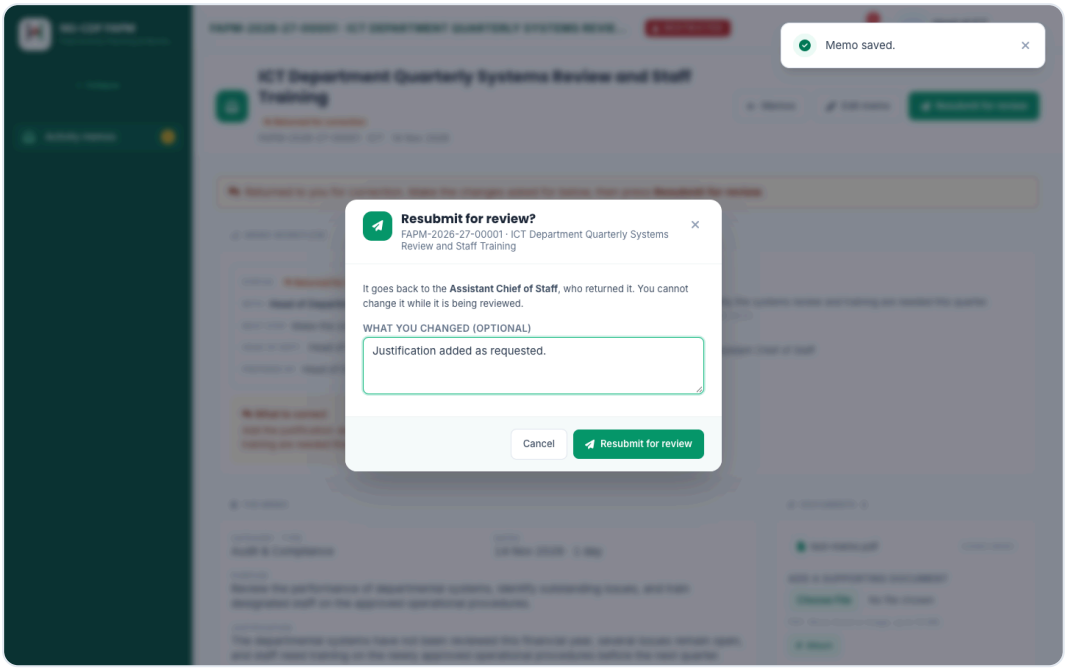


Figure 13. Resubmitting, with a short note of what changed.

8. Preparing a memo on a Head of Department's behalf

The Assistant Chief of Staff or Chief of Staff can record a memo for a Head of Department, for example one received on paper. The system records both people: the **Head of Department** responsible, and **you** as the person who prepared it. You never sign in as the Head of Department.

1. On **Activity memos**, press **Prepare a memo for a Head of Department** (or **Record activity** in the register).
2. Choose the **Requesting department**, then the **Head of Department**. If that department has no account yet, type the Head of Department's name instead.
3. Fill in the memo, attach the signed memo, and press **Save draft**.
4. Add the team, then press **Forward to CEO**. It does not need to be submitted by the Head of Department, who can follow it on their own board.

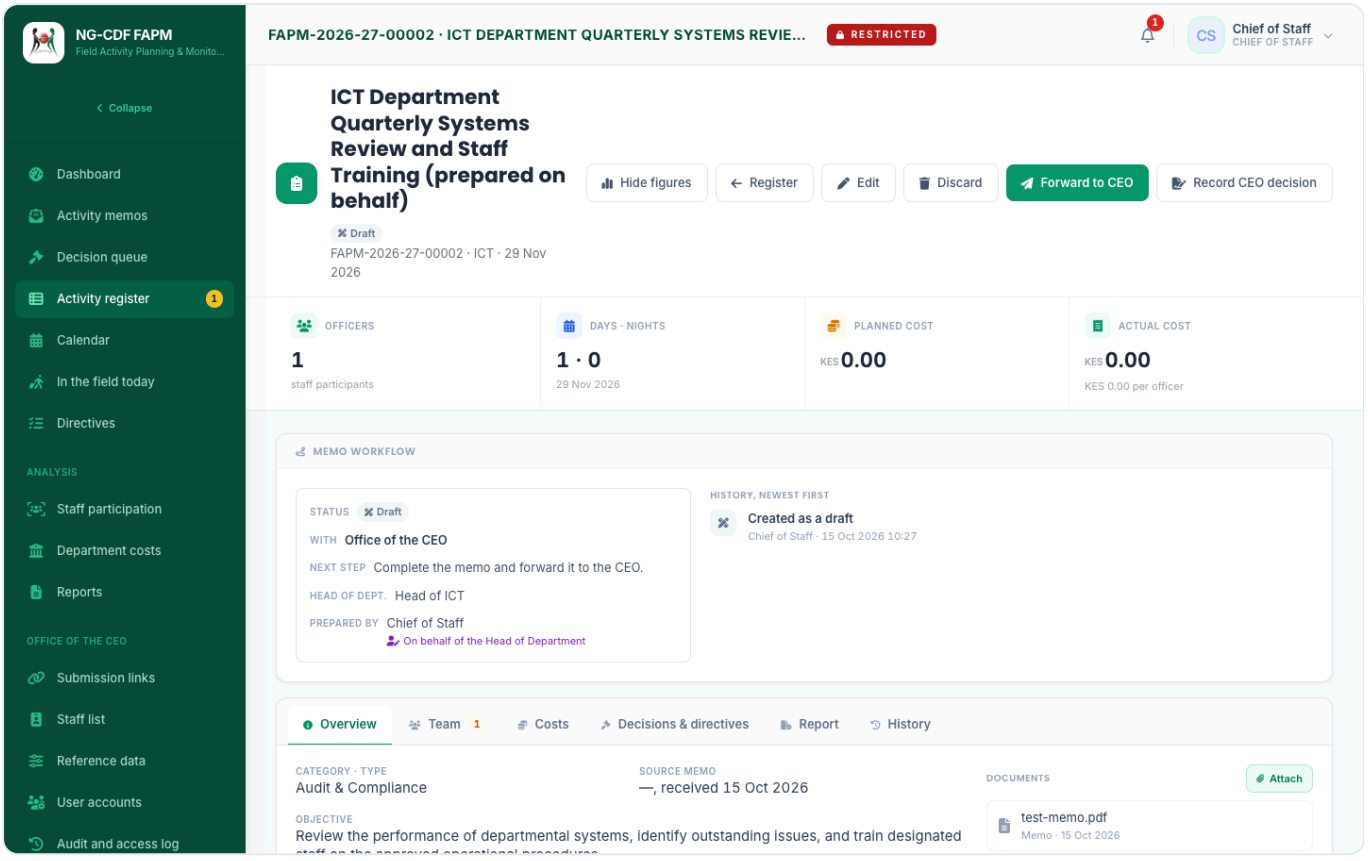


Figure 14. A memo prepared by the Chief of Staff: **Prepared by Chief of Staff, on behalf of the Head of Department**; Head of Dept.: Head of ICT.

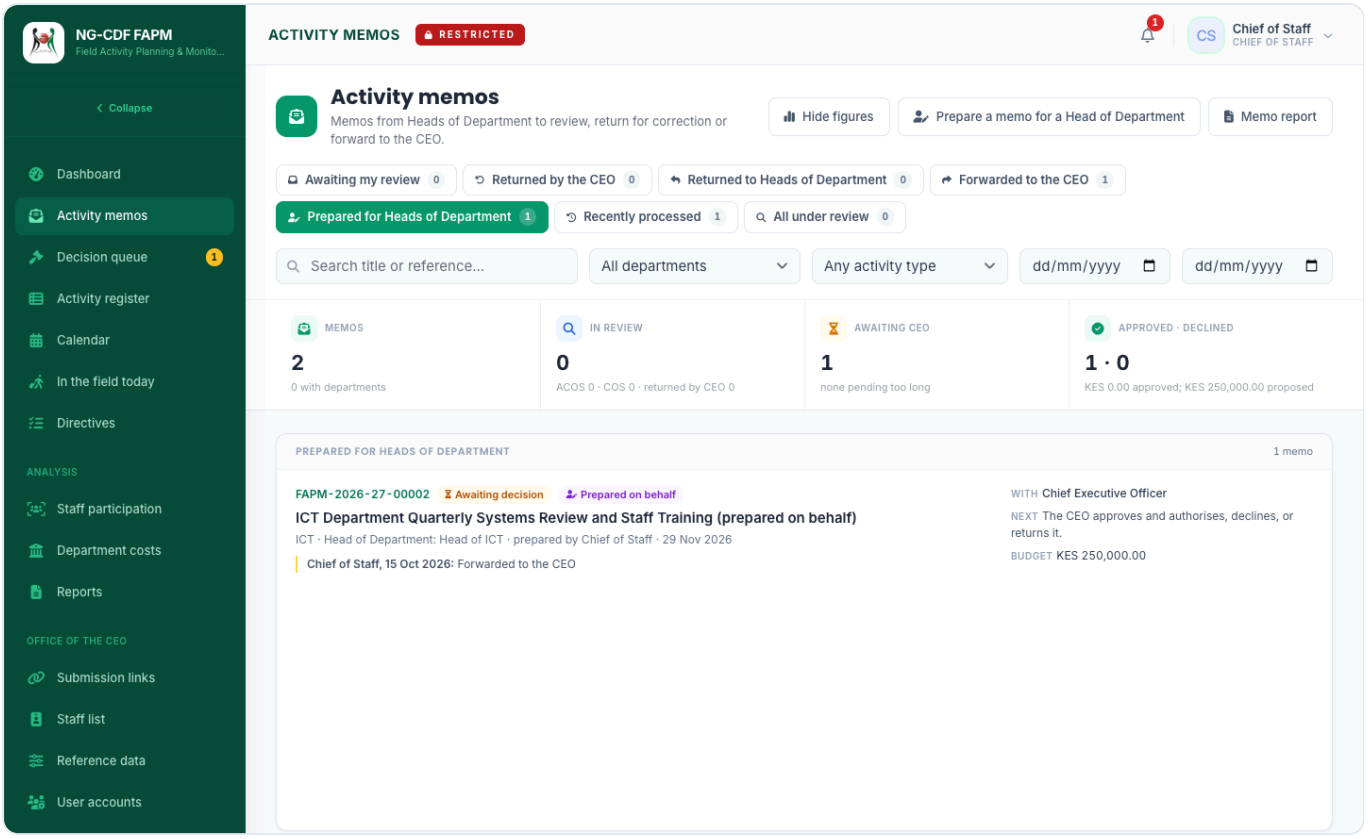


Figure 15. The **Prepared for Heads of Department** tab lists every memo prepared on someone's behalf, marked **Prepared on behalf**.

9. CEO: approve and authorise, decline, or return

1. Open **Activity memos** (tab **Awaiting my approval**) or the **Decision queue**. Each memo shows the dates, place, team, planned cost, the Head of Department and the reviewer's latest comment and recommendation.
2. Open the memo for the full details, documents and history if you need them.
3. Choose one:
   - **Approve and authorise**: a comment is optional.
   - **Decline**: a reason is required.
   - **Return**: a directive or comment is required. The memo goes back to the Chief of Staff and Assistant, who may pass it to the Head of Department.
4. Confirm in the popup. The decision, your name, the date and time and your comment are recorded and cannot be changed. The Office of the CEO and the Head of Department are alerted.

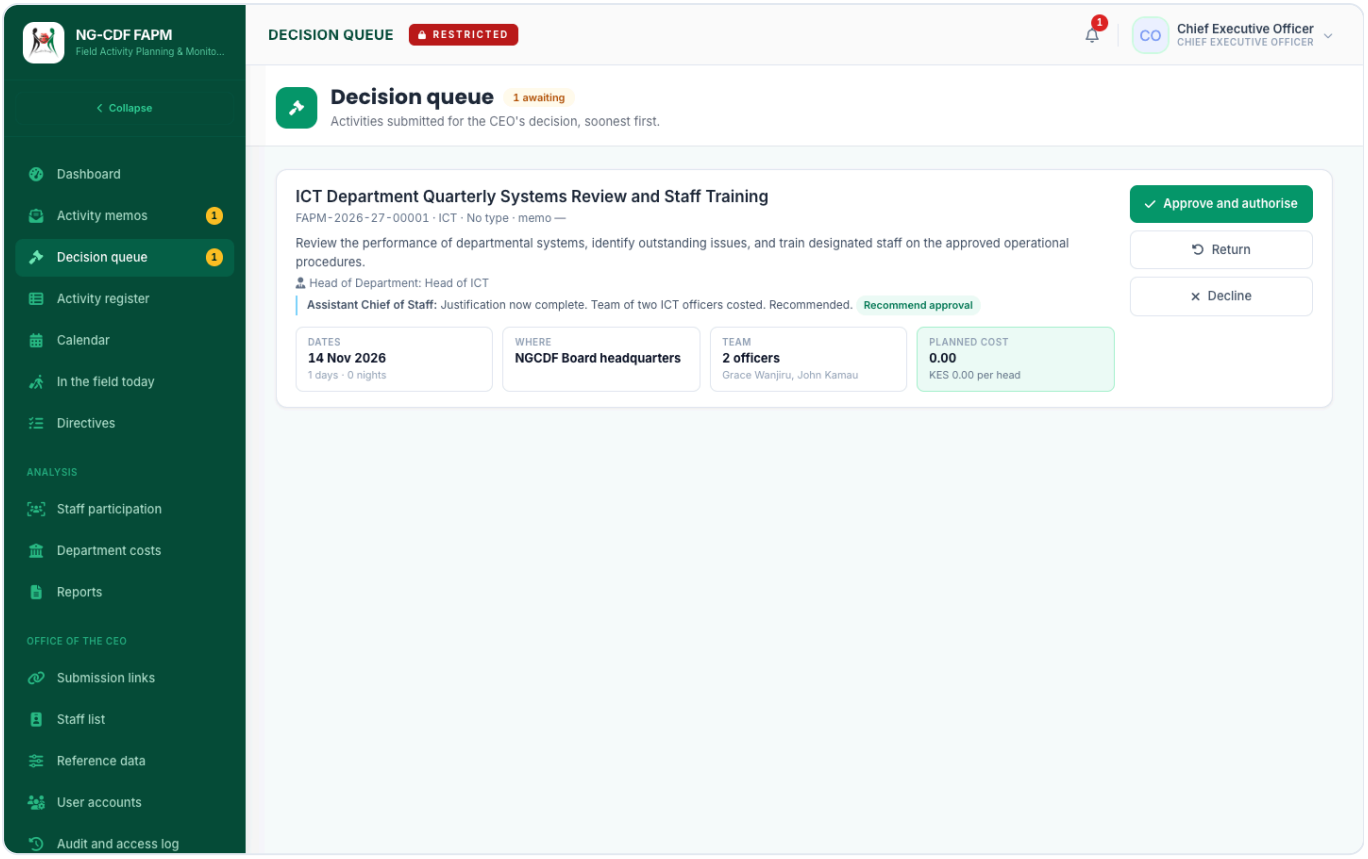


Figure 16. The CEO's decision queue, showing the reviewer's recommendation next to the memo.

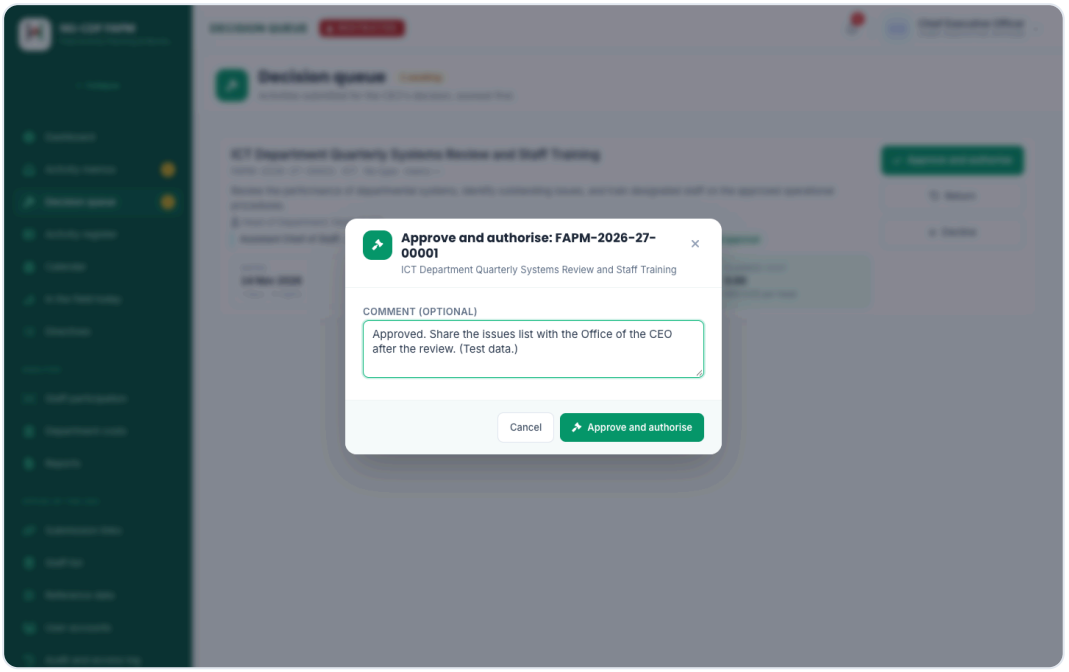


Figure 17. Approving and authorising, with an optional comment.

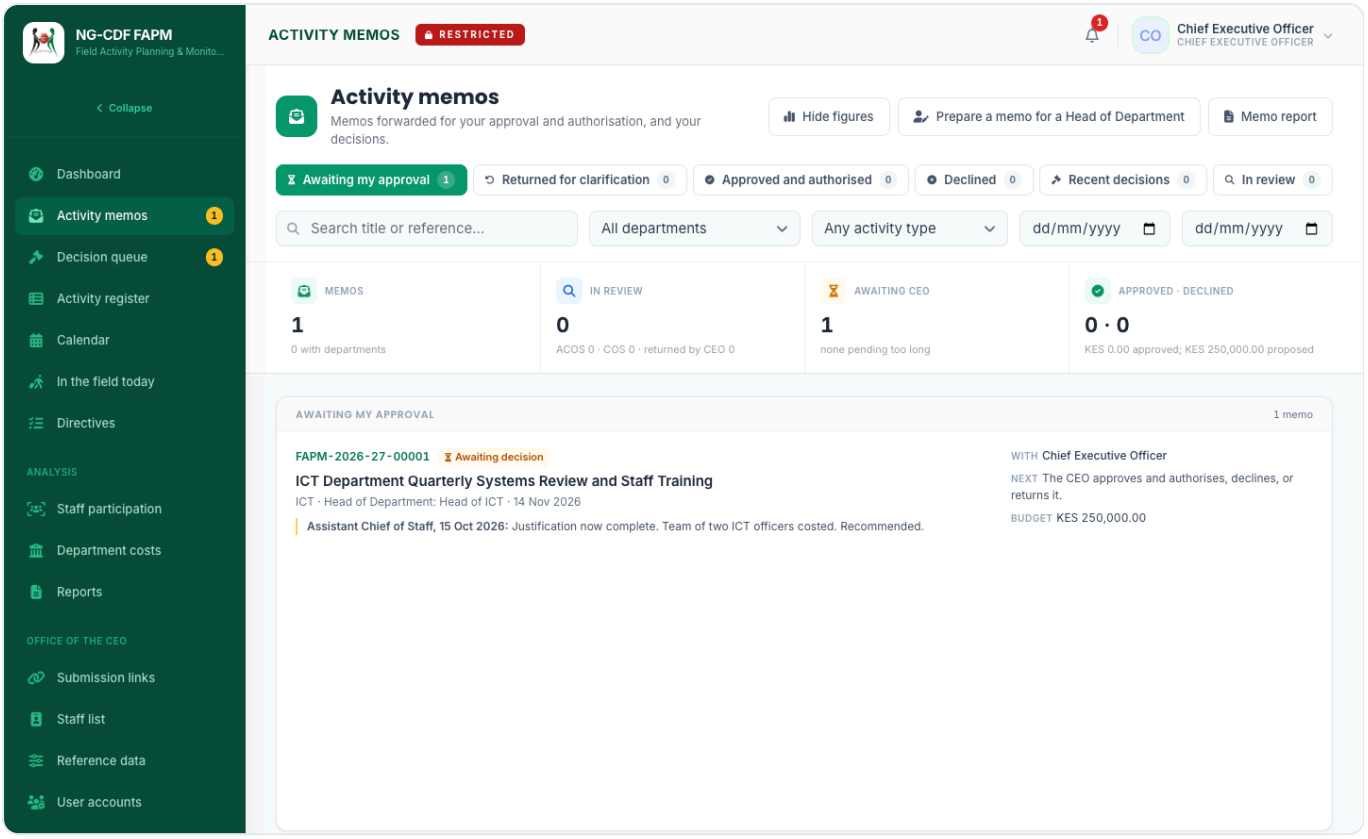


Figure 18. The CEO's memo board: Awaiting my approval, Returned for clarification, Approved and authorised, Declined, Recent decisions, In review.

An approval cannot happen by accident

The CEO can decide only a memo that has been forwarded. A memo is never marked approved just because it was forwarded, and two decisions made at the same moment cannot both be saved.

10. Following memos: status, alerts and reports

- **Memo board.** Every role has tabs for what concerns them. The first tab is what needs your action; its count is shown in yellow.
- **Alerts.** The bell at the top right lists alerts. Click one to open the memo. Alerts tell you what to do, for example "Returned for correction, please revise and resubmit".
- **Reminders.** A memo left under review or awaiting decision for longer than the reminder period (3 working days by default) is marked **Pending since** on the board, and the person holding it gets a daily reminder.
- **History.** The Memo workflow panel shows every step, newest first, with who did it and when.

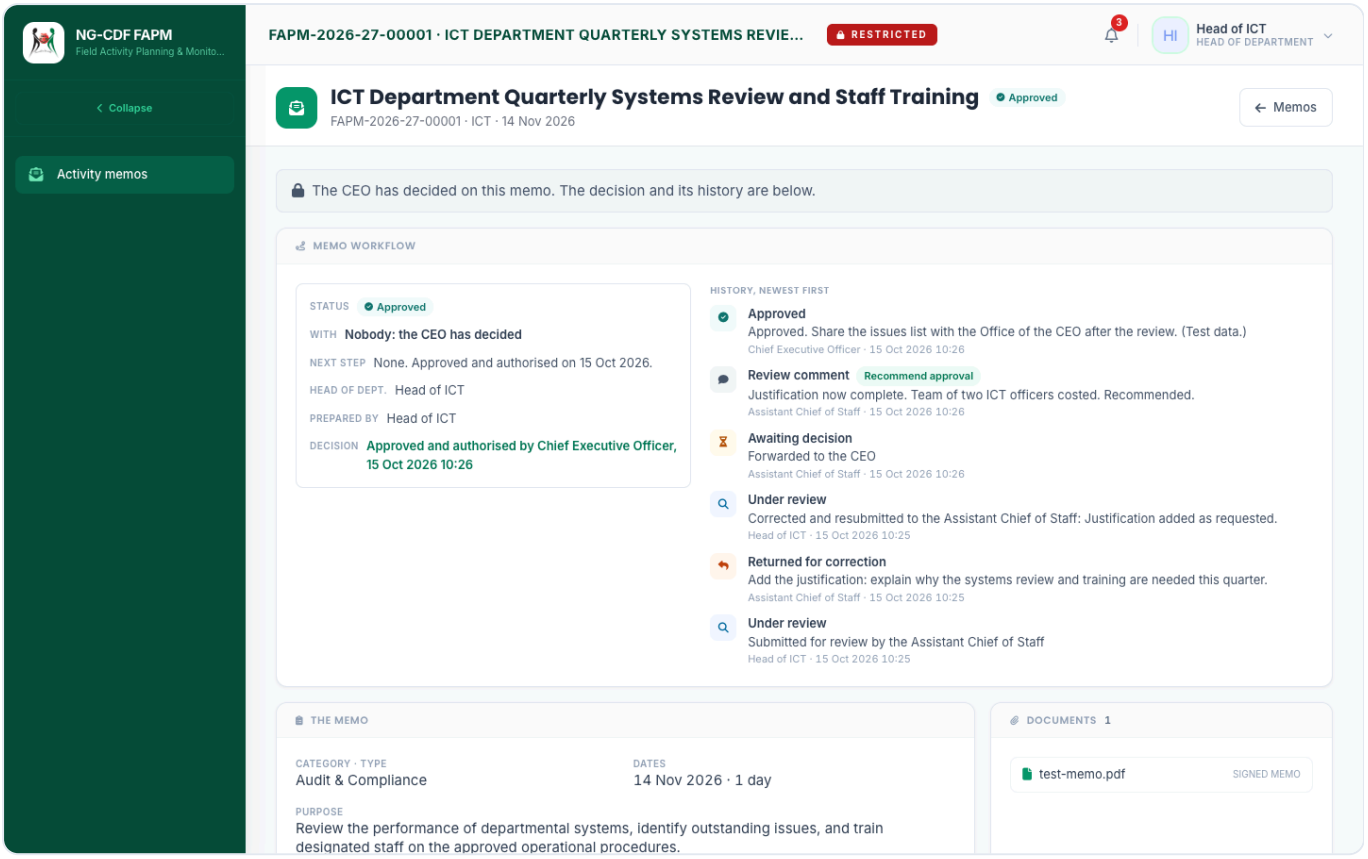


Figure 19. What the Head of ICT sees after approval: approved and authorised by the Chief Executive Officer, with the date, time and full history.

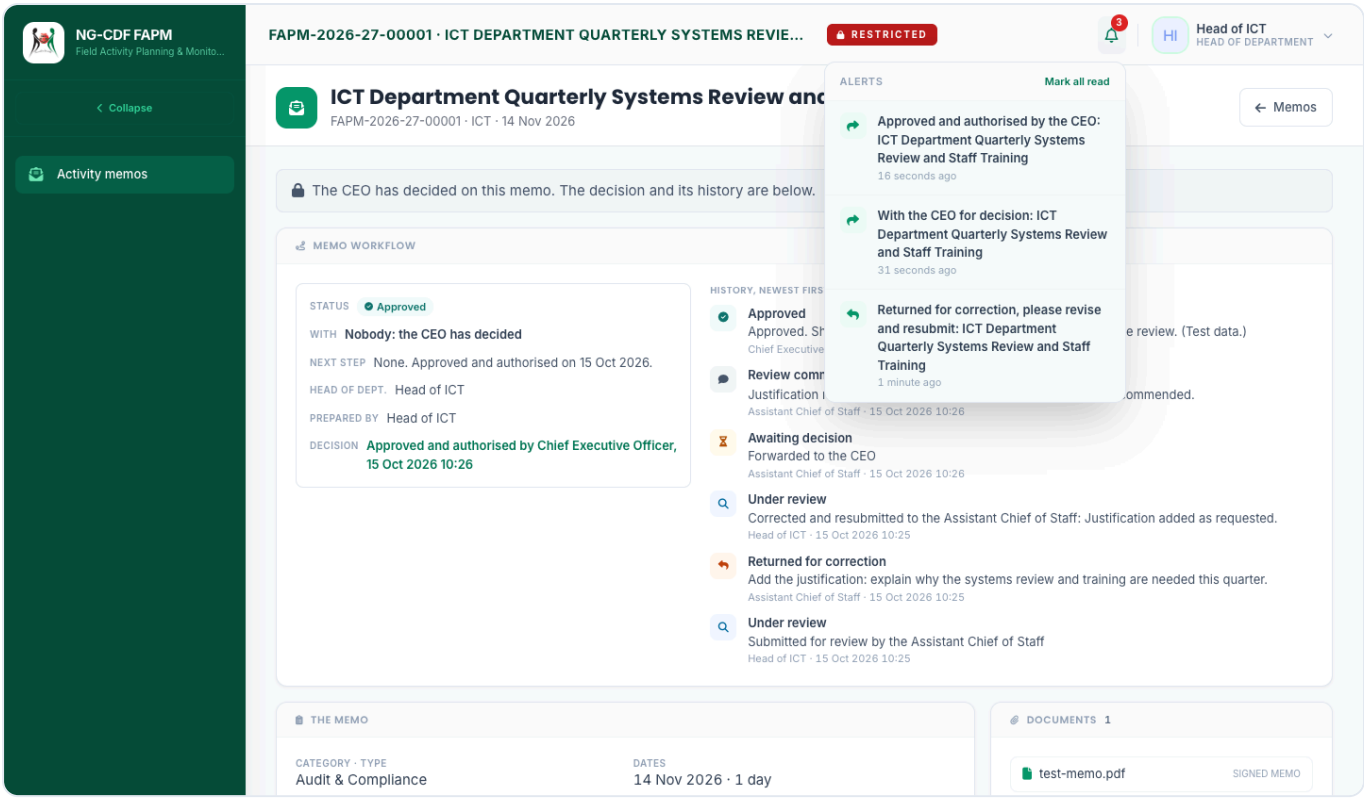


Figure 20. The Head of Department's alerts as the memo moved: returned, with the CEO, approved and authorised.

The Activity Memo Workflow report

The Office of the CEO can open **Reports › Activity Memo Workflow** (or Memo report on the board). For each memo it shows the department, Head of Department, who prepared it, status, who has it, the submission date, the days spent with the department, in review and with the CEO, whether it is pending too long, the department's estimate, the costed plan, the approved amount and the decision date. Filter by financial year, quarter, dates and department, and export to Excel, PDF or print. Each memo is counted once, however many times it was returned.

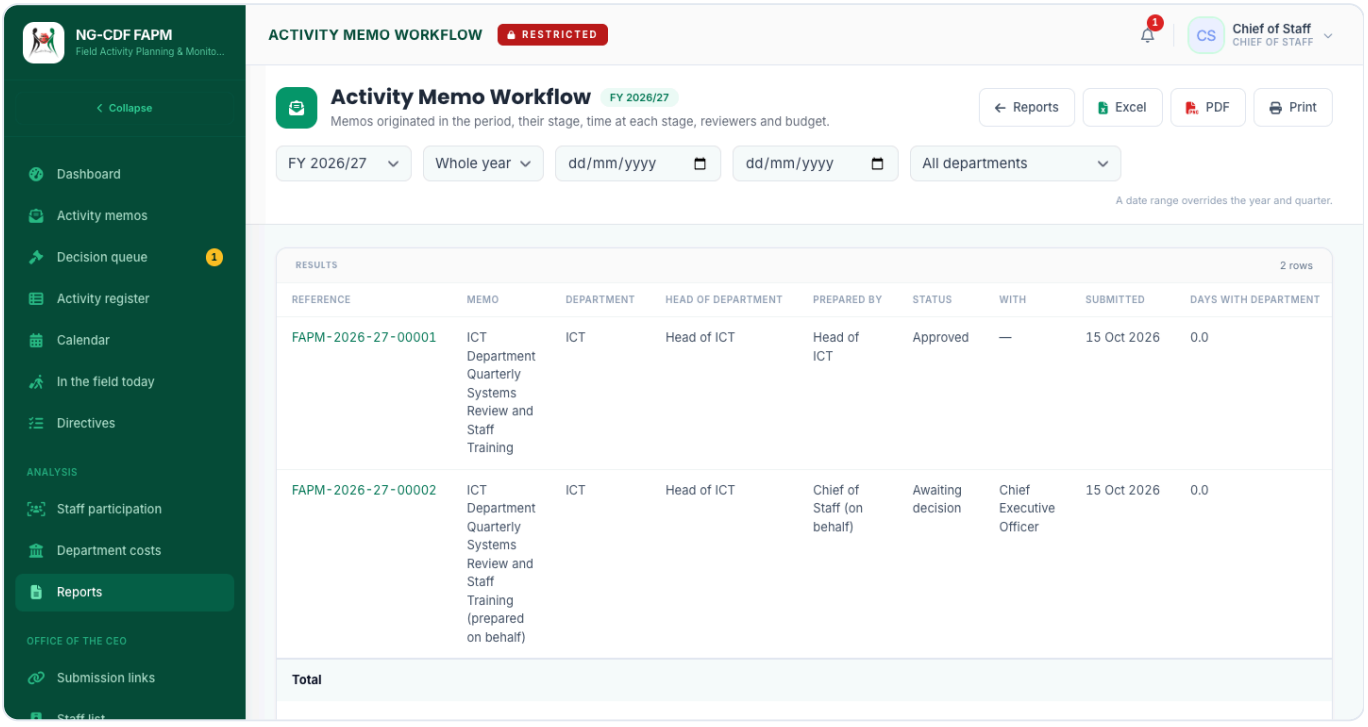


Figure 21. The Activity Memo Workflow report with the two test memos.

11. System Administrator: accounts and the route setting

Head of Department accounts

1. Open **User accounts**. Under **Heads of Department**, press **Add Head of Department**.
2. Enter the name and email and choose the **Department**. Save, then share the one-time password privately.
3. Each department has one active Head of Department. When the holder changes, **Deactivate** the old account first. Use **Change department** if a Head of Department moves.

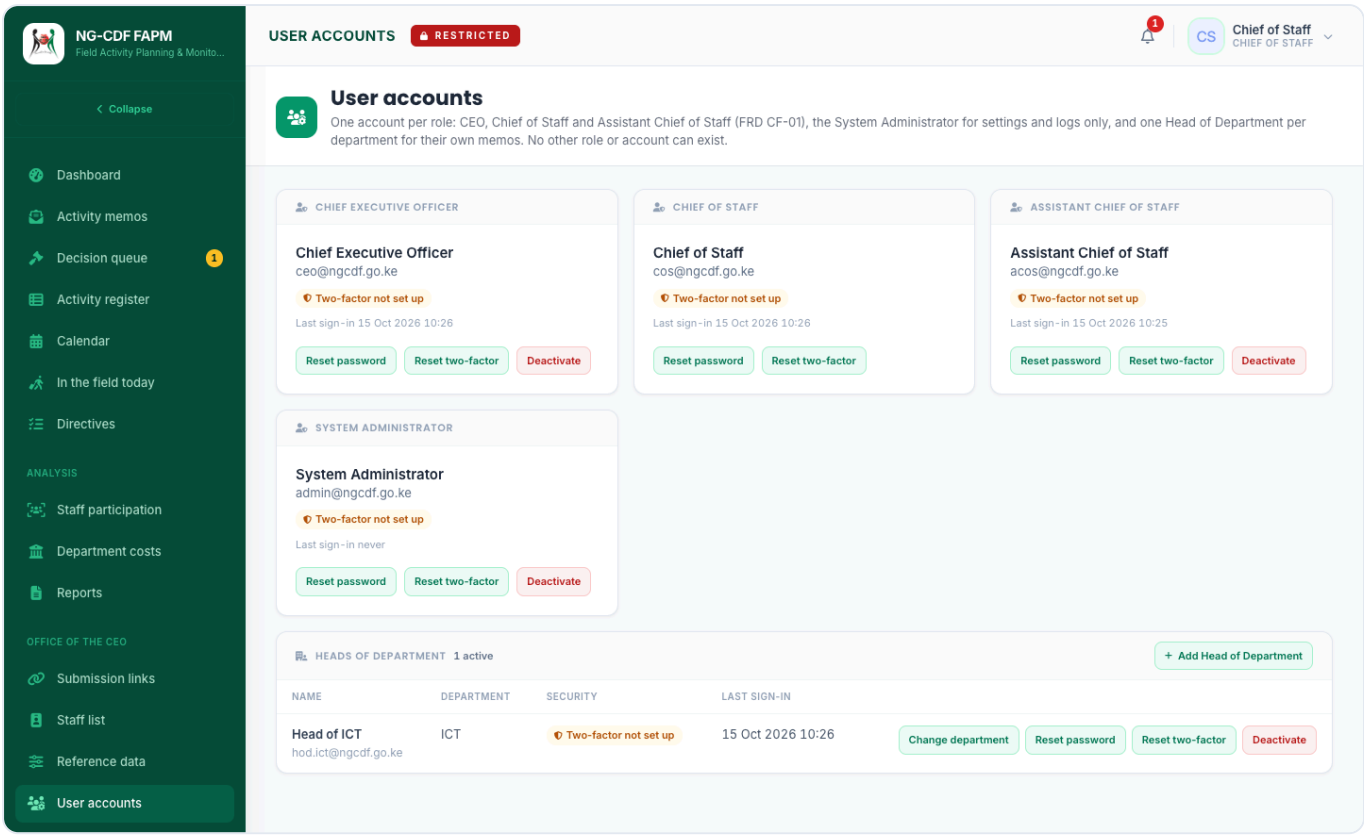


Figure 22. User accounts, with the Heads of Department section.

Review route and reminder period

Under **Reference data › Thresholds**: **Assistant's memos go through the Chief of Staff** (No by default: the Assistant may forward straight to the CEO) and **Memo pending reminder (working days)** (3 by default). Changes are recorded in the audit log.

> **The System Administrator cannot see or decide memos**
> Account and settings changes never alter a memo, a comment or a decision.

12. Common mistakes and how to fix them

What you see	Why, and what to do
"Add the venue or location before submitting."	Press **Edit memo** and fill in the venue (or county), then submit again.
"Attach the signed memo or concept note before submitting."	Use the **Documents** panel on the memo page, press **Attach**, then submit.
There is no Edit memo button.	The memo is with the Office of the CEO or decided. It can be changed only after it is returned to you.
"Add at least one staff participant first." (reviewer)	Open the **Team** tab, press **Add officers** and add the officers, then forward.
"This memo is with the Chief of Staff for review." (Assistant)	The memo has moved to the Chief of Staff. Follow it under **All under review**.
"There is no active Head of Department account for this department …"	Nobody can receive the return. Make the correction yourself, or ask the System Administrator to create the account.
"Someone else changed this memo a moment ago." or "Someone else saved this memo after you opened it."	Another person acted first. Reload the page to see where the memo is now, then act again if still needed.
A toast says DSA was not calculated.	The location has no county, so no allowance rate applies. Add a county on the memo page or enter costs on the Costs tab.
I cannot see another department's memo.	Correct: a Head of Department sees only their own department.
I was signed out.	Sessions end after 15 minutes without activity. Sign in again; saved work is kept.

13. Testing checklist

Use test accounts and test data only. Tick each item when you have seen it work. These scenarios were run in the system on 15 October 2026 to produce the screenshots in this guide.

Scenario 1: memo from the Head of Department

- [ ] Head of ICT creates "ICT Department Quarterly Systems Review and Staff Training" (one day, NGCDF Board headquarters, illustrative KES 250,000) and saves it as a draft.
- [ ] Submit is refused until the venue and signed memo are present.
- [ ] Head of ICT submits to the Assistant Chief of Staff; status **Under review**; ACOS alerted.
- [ ] Head of ICT can no longer edit the memo.
- [ ] ACOS returns it for the missing justification; a reason is required.
- [ ] Head of ICT sees "What to correct", adds the justification and resubmits; it returns to the ACOS.
- [ ] ACOS adds a team member and forwards to the CEO with "Recommend approval".
- [ ] Status **Awaiting decision**; the memo is **not** approved yet.
- [ ] CEO approves and authorises with a comment.
- [ ] History shows every step with names and times; the Head of ICT is alerted.

Scenario 2: prepared on behalf

- [ ] Chief of Staff prepares the same type of memo for ICT, choosing Head of ICT as Head of Department.
- [ ] Memo shows "Prepared by Chief of Staff, on behalf of the Head of Department".
- [ ] It appears under **Prepared for Heads of Department**.
- [ ] COS forwards it to the CEO; the Head of ICT can see it but not change it.
- [ ] CEO approves; the report lists it once, "Chief of Staff (on behalf)".

Controls

- [ ] Another department's Head cannot open the ICT memo or its documents.
- [ ] Head of Department cannot open the register, dashboard or reports.
- [ ] Declining and returning require a reason.
- [ ] With the route setting on Yes, the Assistant's forward goes to the Chief of Staff.
- [ ] A memo pending longer than the reminder period is flagged.

> **Reminder**
> The amounts, names and approvals in this guide and in testing are illustrative test data and do not represent any institutional decision.